

Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

AIM:

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create a sample application, explore the core platform architecture (Develop, Deploy, Manage), and understand its user interface components.

SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR:

(i) Create the Sample Application

1. **Sign Up / Log In:** Navigate to the Zoho Creator website and sign up for a free trial or log into an existing Zoho account.
2. **Access the Dashboard:** Once logged in, click on the **+ Create Application** or **Create From Scratch** button on the main homepage.
3. **Application Details:** Name the application (e.g., *"Sales Tracker"* or *"Employee Directory"*) and click **Create** to launch the low-code development workspace.

(ii) Component Explanations

1. Creating a Form

Explanation: A Form is the data collection engine of Zoho Creator. It utilizes a drag-and-drop interface containing various field types like text, numbers, dropdowns, and dates. When a user submits a form, the input data is validated and securely stored as a new record in the underlying database table.

Corporate Asset Maintenance & Management Request

+

Done

Basic Fields

Name

Email

Address

Phone

Single Line

Multi Line

123

Date

Request ID

Asset

Requested By

Department

Issue Category

Issue Description

Priority

Estimated Repair Cost

Labour Charge

Field Properties

Field name

Request ID

Field link name

Request_ID

View Field References

Validation

Start index

1001

Appearance

Field type

Auto Number

Chat

Connect

Here is your Smart Chat (Ctrl+Space)

Trial has expired | Upgrade

Help

2. Creating a Report

Explanation: A Report visualizes and organizes the raw data collected through your forms. It allows developers to present information in diverse formats such as lists, grids, Kanban boards, or calendars. Reports also support data manipulation features including advanced filtering, sorting, and conditional formatting.

CAM Corporate Asset Management1

Department

Department

Department Report

Asset Details

Technician

Maintenance Request

Maintenance Approval

Repair Progress

Vishaal

Department Report

Department Name

Department ID

Department Head

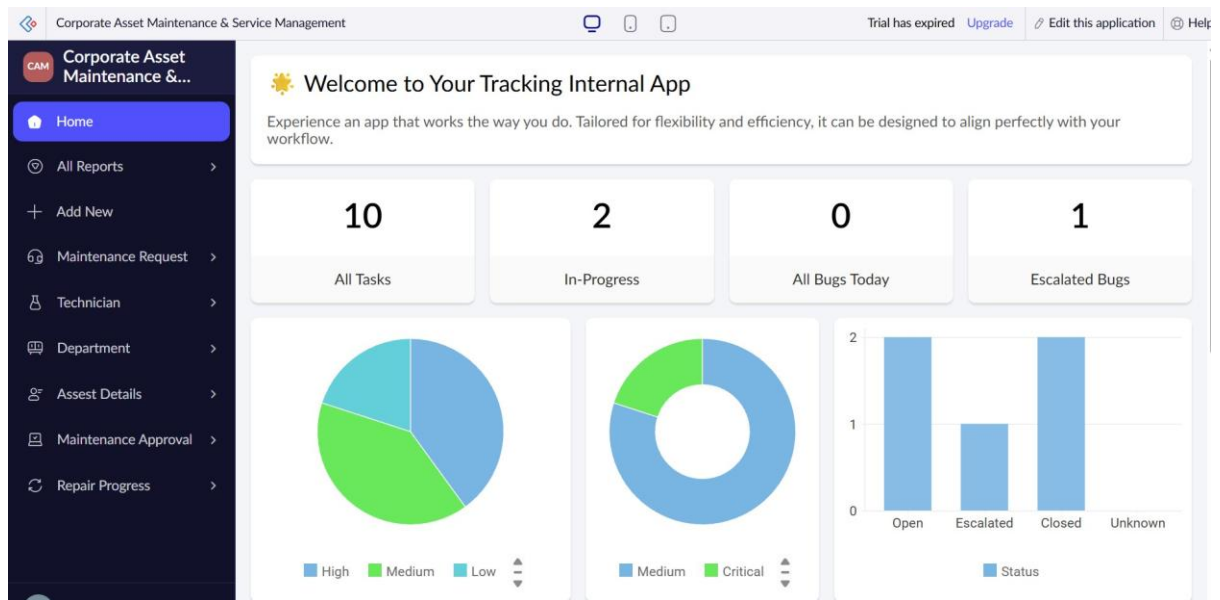
Department Location

SALES	1003	vishaal.s.2024.cse_rajala930	PORUR
	1002		
IT	1001	vishaal.s.2024.cse_rajala930	1ST FLOOR

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3. Creating a Dashboard

Explanation: A Dashboard (Pages) serves as an interactive canvas for executive summaries and analytics. It consolidates multiple forms, reports, custom buttons, and visual widgets like charts or KPIs into a single screen. This interface gives users a centralized, high-level overview of key business metrics in real-time.



EXPLORING THE PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE:

Develop

- The **Develop** environment provides a drag-and-drop canvas alongside Zoho's proprietary scripting language, Deluge, to build applications.
- Developers can visually design user interfaces, structure database tables through forms, and automate complex workflows without writing extensive code.
- It features built-in tools for input validation, conditional visibility rules, and instant live previews of the application layout across desktop and mobile devices.

Deploy

- The **Deploy** architecture automates the application lifecycle by instantly hosting the software on Zoho's secure cloud infrastructure.
- It eliminates the need for manual server configuration, database provisioning, or platform-specific compilation for mobile application environments.

- Updates and new features published by the creator are pushed to end-users instantly in real-time without causing application downtime.

Manage

- The **Manage** console gives administrators central control over user access, data security governance, and system maintenance.
- It features role-based access control (RBAC) to define exactly who can view, edit, or delete specific data records within the platform.
- The backend also tracks system activity logs, performance metrics, and handles third-party API integration connections seamlessly.